higher education & training

Department:
Higher Education and Training
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

NATIONAL CERTIFICATE (VOCATIONAL)

TOURISM OPERATIONS
NQF LEVEL 2

(11011072)

22 November 2019 (Y-Paper)
13:00–16:00

This question paper consists of 8 pages and two addenda of 3 pages.

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TIME: 3 HOURS
MARKS: 150

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. Answer ALL the questions.
2. Read ALL the questions carefully.
3. Number the answers according to the numbering system used in this question paper.
4. Write neatly and legibly.

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SECTION A

QUESTION 1

1.1 Indicate whether the following statements are TRUE or FALSE. Choose the answer and write only 'True' or 'False' next to the question number (1.1.1–1.1.5) in the ANSWER BOOK.

1.1.1 Office records like client booking files are essential to assist management with decision making on products and services.

1.1.2 Front office personnel ignoring a client who walks in while you are talking on the phone is not an offence.

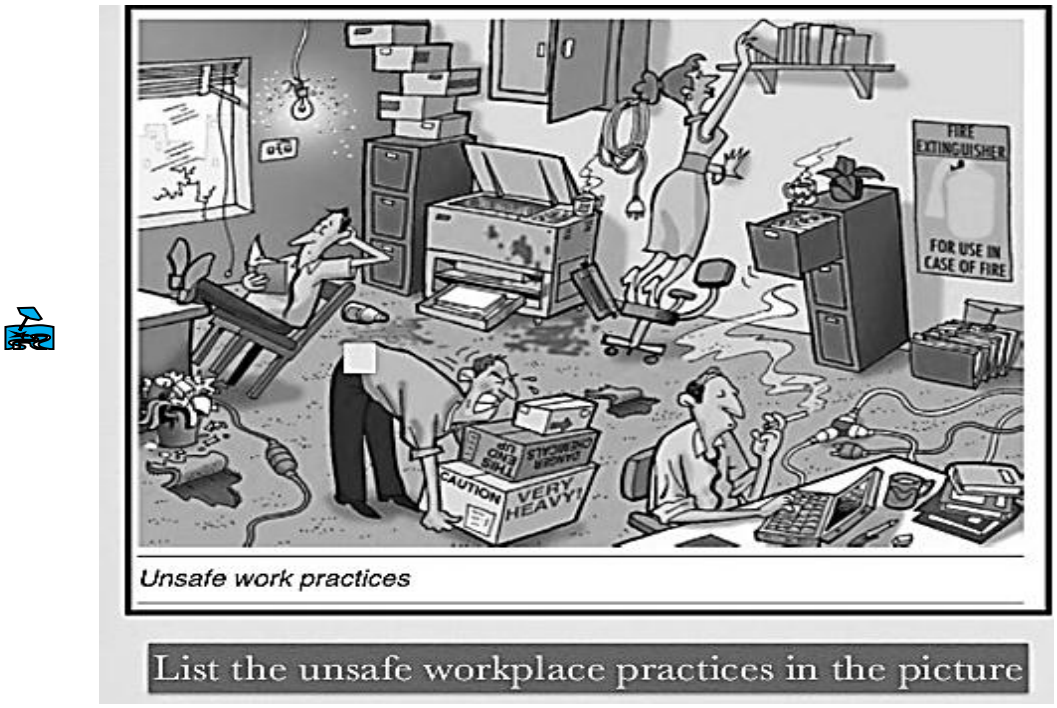
1.1.3 Upon receiving a call regarding a safety risk or security emergency at work, leaving the building immediately is the safest action to be taken.

1.1.4 Presentations and shows in which telecommunications technology is used will NOT improve knowledge of a new telephone system.

1.1.5 Leaving guillotines and staplers lying around in an office is not a dangerous action.

(5 × 1) (5)

1.2 The picture below depicts an unsafe office. Identify any FOUR risks from this picture. Use ADDENDUM A to answer the question and indicate if the risk is a situation or an action.



(4 × 3) (12)

1.3 Choose a description from COLUMN B that matches a term in COLUMN A. Write only the letter (A–G) next to the question number (1.3.1–1.3.5) in the ANSWER BOOK.

COLUMN A		COLUMN B	
1.3.1	Classified information	A	multiple purpose document
1.3.2	Equipment not responding	B	cash and foreign currencies
1.3.3	Marketing material	C	agreements
1.3.4	Standard traffic document	D	routine problem
1.3.5	Valuable items in a travel agency	E	strategic plans
		F	invoices and faxes
		G	brochures and pamphlets

(5 × 1) (5)

1.4 Complete the following sentences by filling in the missing word(s). Write only the word(s) next to the question number (1.4.1–1.4.5) in the ANSWER BOOK.

1.4.1 An agreement consists of an offer by at least one party and the … thereof by at least another party.

1.4.2 When the payment point is not properly secured, there are … to both staff and the business.

1.4.3 A confidentiality or security breach occurs when confidential information is … to unauthorised sources.

1.4.4 One of the duties of travel consultants is to advise and assist travellers with passports, visas and … requirements.

1.4.5 A warranty will not be honoured if repairs or attempted repairs were made to an appliance by any … other than an authorised person.

(5 × 1) (5)

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1.5 Give ONE word or a term for each of the following descriptions by choosing a word or term from the list below. Write only the word or term next to the question number (1.5.1–1.5.3) in the ANSWER BOOK.

secret; industrial espionage; classified; confidential; top secret

1.5.1 Information that is only disclosed to certain staff members as indicated by the manager

1.5.2 Information that is sensitive and that may be disclosed to middle or top management

1.5.3 Deliberate spying on your competition for the purpose of finding information about their new equipment

(3 × 1) (3)
[30]

TOTAL SECTION A: 30

SECTION B

Answer ALL the questions in SECTION B.

QUESTION 2: Use ADDENDUM B to answer the questions.

2.1 At 10:00 am, a travel consultant has an enquiring about a honeymoon package to Mauritius. When helping this couple, she has to check the availability of flights, accommodation and attractions at the destination. In this process, a perfect match is not always possible, and you can see that it has taken her an hour to reach an agreement with her clients.

2.1.1 Name EIGHT key aspects that a travel consultant must always bear in mind while checking for availability in order to achieve a mutually satisfactory outcome. (8)

2.1.2 Identify and describe from the scenario the type of travel agency on ADDENDUM B. (2 + 2) (4)

2.2 At 11:15 am, the travel consultant retrieves booking information for a client who booked the day before.

2.2.1 What filing system does she use? (2)

2.2.2 Provide SEVEN advantages for a travel agency of the filing system mentioned in QUESTION 2.2.1. (7)

2.3 Travel agents act as information centres for tourists.

What important information was requested from this travel consultant about travelling to Africa? (2)

2.4 Name ONE authorised form of payment that may be used by the couple mentioned in QUESTION 2.2.1 when paying for their honeymoon package. (1)

2.5 At 12:30 pm, another client walks into the agency, at the very moment that the computer system crashes. As travel agents, we rely on our systems to find information, as well as to check availability and book accommodation. This is referred to downtime and it is usually due to technical problems or a power failure. The travel consultant must exercise proper crisis control.

Describe what proper crisis control would involve in the situation above. (6)
[30]

QUESTION 3: Use ADDENDUM B to answer the questions.

3.1 The tourism and hospitality industry has different sectors that provide tourism products and services to the tourism industry.

From ADDENDUM B, identify THREE businesses from these different sectors and give an example of each from your province. Write your answer next to the question number (3.1.1–3.1.3) in the ANSWER BOOK. (3 + 3) (6)

3.2 At 3:00 pm, a client calls to try to refund a non-refundable ticket. I spend 10 minutes explaining that there is nothing the client can do with a non-refundable ticket. The above situation is just one example of difficult situations which travel consultants have to face on a daily basis.

Recommend THREE basic steps that the travel consultant should follow in dealing with rude, confused, irate or difficult clients. Write your answer next to the question number (3.2.1–3.2.3) in the ANSWER BOOK. (3)

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3.3 Clients in the tourism industry expect travel consultants to treat their business confidentially, but often breach of confidentiality happens.

From the THREE levels of confidentiality breaches, provide your own typical examples of breach of confidentiality that could happen in a travel agency. Mention the level and give your own example of each. Write your answer next to the question number (3.3.1–3.3.3) in the ANSWER BOOK. (4 × 3) (12)

3.4 In the travel industry, use of telephonic alphabet is very important to avoid any confusion with client names, especially with flight bookings.

Spell the following client's surname using the telephonic alphabet:

Richy (5)

3.5 As a consultant operating from your simulation room, list the FOUR different ways in which you can contact service providers, suppliers or principals. (4)

[30]

QUESTION 4

4.1



In the wrong hands, confidential information can be misused to commit illegal activities (e.g. fraud or discrimination), which, in turn, can result in costly lawsuits for the employer.

You are requested to draw up a proposed policy on confidentiality. The policy should have the company name and SIX confidentiality guidelines.

(2 × 6 + 3) (15)

4.2 Putting calls on hold is unavoidable for a switchboard operator. What will be the correct thing to do in the following situations?

4.2.1 When the extension is engaged (2)

4.2.2 When there is no reply from the extension (2)

4.3 Showing politeness and friendliness is one of the key skills expected from employees in the travel, tourism and hospitality industry. Employees are expected to consider the pleasing principle whenever they are dealing with clients.

Explain the *pleasing principle*. (8)

4.4 Operating the payment point in any tourism business requires one to go through a process of pre-operation check.

List THREE consumables or items of stationery that you should check at the commencement of every shift. (3)

[30]

QUESTION 5

5.1 As a pay-point operator in a tourism business, you have the responsibility, from time to time, to order float (change) at the start of your shift.

Design a proper change requisition form that you would use to order float. (9)

5.2 When speaking to a client over the phone, the client cannot see you, and factors like pace, pitch, volume, emphasis and clarity will affect your communication.

As an employee in the tourism industry, provide a conversation that you had with your client. It should have THREE items that you are emphasising. Underline the emphasised words. (3)

5.3 At the end of the shift in any business, hand-over procedures need to be followed by pay-point operators, and sometimes the pay-point operator may have a shortage.

Give FOUR guidelines to be followed to prevent the pay-point operator from experiencing a shortage. (2 × 4) (8)

5.4 Explain the interrelationship between the main sectors of the tourism industry, giving your own examples. (4)

5.5 Decode the following acronyms:

5.5.1 CRS

5.5.2 CRO

5.5.3 GDS

(2 × 3) (6)

[30]

TOTAL SECTION B: 120
GRAND TOTAL: 150

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ADDENDUM A **EXAMINATION NUMBER:**

QUESTION 1.2

RISK	SITUATION	ACTION	POSSIBLE SOLUTION

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ADDENDUM B

A DAY IN THE LIFE OF A TRAVEL AGENT

Posted by Oxbridge Academy | Oct 6, 2014 | Career Tips and Advice, Tourism and Hospitality



If you're working in the travel and tourism industry, you will more than likely be helping people plan various aspects of their holidays. Travel agents also help their clients figure out how to get the best value out of their travel budgets.

The day starts: It's 6 in the morning and my alarm clock rings. It's time to kick-start my day with a cup of coffee before I head for the office.

8:30 am: I arrive at the office after spending almost an hour in traffic, make my second cup of coffee for the day, catch up on weekend gossip, and head over to my desk to catch up on e-mails that came in over the weekend. As we're a small team, one of us is always on standby over the weekend. We must be available to help clients in case of travel emergencies.

10:00 am: My first clients arrive – they're a young couple planning their honeymoon to Mauritius. A big part of my job entails advising clients on locations and destinations, and in this case, Mauritius is the perfect honeymoon destination. We go through the honeymoon brochures together, and I check the system for flight and hotel availability. After I've spent an hour with the clients, they finally agree on a hotel and I manage to make the booking.

11:15 am: A client who booked a flight yesterday calls to change the flight. I retrieve his information from the computer and advise him on alternative dates. Most of the flights are full, therefore I put him on a waiting list and promise to stay on top of it and to inform him when it clears.

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ADDENDUM B (cont.)

12:00 pm: Some regular clients' calls, wanting to book a trip for the whole family to Walt Disney World. First, I check the dates at which they would like to travel and then the system for flight availability. As they want to travel in peak season, flights are full and I have to advise the clients to travel at different dates. They're not very happy but agree to change their travel dates. Crisis averted!

12:30 pm: Another client walks into the agency, at the very moment that the computer system crashes. As travel agents, we rely on our systems to find information, as well as to check availability and book accommodation. I take down all the necessary details and do what I can over the phone with the airline. The client tells me he will come back later. Hopefully, our systems will be up and running by then.

1:00 pm: The system is up! I eat a quick lunch at my desk while I read e-mails and check phone messages.

2:00 pm: I work with a couple of corporate clients and mostly deal with executive personal assistants. I've received a number of enquiries about the Ebola virus in Africa and whether it's safe to travel to the affected countries.

3:00 pm: A client calls to try to refund a non-refundable ticket. I spend 10 minutes explaining that there is nothing the client can do with a non-refundable ticket.

4:00 pm: Another client calls from the airport – their reservation has been cancelled, even though they have their ticket with them. I calmly speak to the reservation consultant at the airport and sort out the problem.

4:30 pm: It's almost the end of a very long day. I catch up on administrative matters and help a number of colleagues with reservations.

5:30 pm: Time to head home. After today, I feel like I need a holiday.

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